

THE INTRODUCTION OF A FEW RABBITS COULD DO LITTLE HARM

INVASIVE SPECIES

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURES

Ryan M. Keane, **Michael J. Crawley** (1949–**)**

BEFORE

1951 The International Plant Protection Convention is set up to prevent the introduction and spread of pests of plants and plant products as a result of international trade. It is adopted in many countries.

1958 *The Ecology of Invasions by Plants and Animals* by British ecologist Charles Elton is the first book to be published on invasion biology.

AFTER

2014 Studies of some of the "world's worst" invasive species by ecologists at Queen's University, Belfast, and Stellenbosch University, South Africa, reveal that the ecological impacts of these species could be predicted from their behavior.

Some of the greatest damage to ecosystems is caused by invasive species. These are plants, animals, or other organisms that are not native to an ecosystem but introduced largely through human action, either deliberately or by accident. They can become competitors, predators, parasites, and